

UNIT 57



HUMAN RESOURCES

CONVERSATION

Lena: Morning, everyone. Just a few quick updates. We're going to hire two new designers to help with the next campaign.

Tom: Finally! We've been short on staff for weeks.

Lena: I know. Also, we'll promote Julia so that she can lead the new team.

Maya: That's awesome — she totally deserves it.

Lena: And we might transfer Lucas to the São Paulo branch in order to support the new project there.

Tom: Makes sense. He's been asking for that opportunity.

Lena: Right. But we'll also need to downsize one small unit so that we can manage the budget better.

Maya: Wait, seriously? Again? I understand the budget, but this is stressful. People are already worried about job security, and morale is low.

Tom: Are you sure there's no other way? Couldn't we maybe reduce hours temporarily instead, or reassign tasks?

Lena: I hear you, Maya. We looked at other options, but downsizing this unit is the only realistic choice right now.

Maya: I just hope we handle it carefully. Staff needs transparency — otherwise, panic spreads fast.

Lena: Absolutely. We'll communicate clearly and support anyone affected.



VOCABULARY



Hire



Fire



Promote



Demote



Resign



Retire



Train



Downsize

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Purpose words

We're hiring two new people **to** help with the paperwork.

Yeah, and we changed the computer system **in order to** make things easier.

Good. I hope everyone learns it fast **so that** we can finish work on time.



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EXERCISE 1

Complete with the correct HR verb. Use one of these: retire, train, promote, demote, hire, fire, resign, downsize.

- A. The company decided to _____ new employees to improve customer service.
- B. The manager had to _____ an underperforming worker due to poor performance.
- C. She was _____ to lead the marketing team because of her excellent performance.
- D. The employee decided to _____ after finding a better job opportunity.
- E. The senior staff member decided to _____ early to enjoy more free time.
- F. They needed to _____ the employees on the new software system.
- G. The company decided to _____ the workforce because the department was being closed.
- H. The manager had to _____ the employee to a lower position because of repeated mistakes.

EXERCISE 2

Complete the sentence with the correct word of purpose. Choose to / in order to or so that.

- A. The company decided to hire new employees _____ in order to _____ improve customer service.
- B. She resigned from her position _____ her team could take on new responsibilities.
- C. The manager trained the team _____ handle customer complaints more effectively.
- D. He was promoted _____ the department could function more efficiently.
- E. The company downsized several departments _____ reduce overall expenses.

SUMMARY

Purpose Word	Structure	Use / Meaning	Example
to	to + base verb	Shows a simple purpose .	She studies to improve her English.
in order to	in order to + base verb	Shows purpose as well; more formal than <i>to</i> .	He left early in order to catch the train.
so that	so that + subject + verb	Shows purpose with a complete clause; often used with <i>can</i> , <i>could</i> , <i>will</i> , or <i>would</i>	They work hard so that they can save money.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. hire
- B. fire
- C. promote
- D. resign
- E. retire
- F. train
- G. downsize
- H. demote

Exercise 2

- A. to / in order to
- B. so that
- C. to / in order to
- D. so that
- E. to / in order to